



COLLEGE OF COMPUTER AND INFORMATION SCIENCE

Academic Year 2025 – 2026

I.T. Practicum

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Submitted to:

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Submitted to the Faculty of Mapúa Malayan Colleges Laguna

In Partial Fulfillment of the Requirements for the degree of

Bachelor of Science in Information Technology

Overview of the Practicum Engagement

Company Background

Kooapps is an indie mobile gaming studio and publisher founded by Chun-Kai “CK” Wang, Jonathan Chang, and Stephanie Cheng, with Solon Chen later co-founding Kooapps Philippines Corporation in 2009. The company was first established in 2008 with the headquarters located at 12400 SE 38th St., Bellevue, Washington. Kooapps established the Makati, Philippines branch, officially operating as Kooapps Philippines Corporation, in 2009, serving as the company’s primary game development hub responsible for the development and maintenance of applications and games published by Kooapps.

The company’s roots trace back to the first release of Apple’s Software Development Kit in 2008. This inspired the vision of developing the first SAT flashcard application for the iPhone. Chun-Kai “CK” Wang, along with his two other colleagues from Stanford University, Jonathan Chang and Stephanie Cheng, formed the team that later became Kooapps. The name “Kooapps” was derived from the phrase “Cool Apps” with the main goal of producing cool and entertaining applications.

Kooapps Philippines Corporation was later co-founded by Solon Chen in 2009, who built the company from the ground up. The Philippine branch eventually became Kooapps' primary hub for engineering, Quality Assurance (QA), and creative production. The company's guiding philosophy is embodied in its tagline, "We make games we want to show our friends."

Mission

Kooapps Philippines Corporation aims to create fun, engaging, and high-quality mobile games and applications that will entertain and inspire people around the world.

Dream

Build the first global Filipino gaming brand, one the entire country will be proud of.

Nature of Tasks Assigned

My official position during my internship at Kooapps Philippines Corporation was Quality Assurance (QA) Intern. As a QA intern, I was tasked with manually testing applications against pre-defined test cases, logging and documenting findings during testing, and performing additional QA tasks such as verifying applied bug fixes and researching the latest market trends in the game development industry. These tasks were intended to help ensure applications were free from bugs that could impact user experience, while also supporting the team by researching ideas for features, tools, and improvements that could enhance both the user experience and the QA workflow.

Additionally, I was also tasked with completing a special project, which served as my final internship requirement. Our team chose to prepare a feasibility study report on a QA tool called Qase. The QA tool I evaluated was designed to consolidate multiple QA tools and applications into a single, centralized, cloud-based platform. As part of the feasibility study, I examined how QA workflows can involve multiple tools and applications for different stages of testing and documentation. Hence, my research focused on how to simplify the QA workflow by reducing context switching and enabling work processes to be performed on a single QA tool. Qase was selected from among several existing QA tools because it offered a comprehensive set of features designed to streamline and improve the QA workflow.

Game Development Outputs

Due to the Non-Disclosure Agreement (NDA) governing my internship at Kooapps Philippines Corporation, internal documents, bug reports, test cases, screenshots of sample tasks, and other proprietary materials cannot be included in this report. The following discussion therefore provides a general overview of the outputs and responsibilities performed during the internship without disclosing confidential company information.

During my internship period, I tested various web and mobile applications developed by the company. Through a systematic testing process, I logged and documented over 100 bugs or defects encountered during testing. These defects included issues related to gameplay mechanics, user interface (UI), and other functional aspects of the applications. Once reported, the defects were investigated by the developers to determine their root causes and implement appropriate fixes. I was then responsible for verifying the implemented fixes by retesting the affected functionalities under the same conditions in which the defects were originally encountered.

In addition to application testing, I was frequently engaged in researching the latest market trends in the game development industry. The research focused on identifying emerging technologies that could enhance user experience and improve the overall Quality Assurance (QA) process. This involved evaluating various third-party software solutions and other technologies relevant to game development and quality assurance. The information gathered served as a reference for discussions on potential process improvements and product enhancements.

Total Hours Rendered

The table below presents a summary of the different phases of my internship at Kooapps Philippines Corporation and the corresponding number of hours rendered for each phase.

Table 1. Summary of Hours Rendered

Phase of Training	Hours Allotted
Company Orientation	8 hours
Quality Assurance Training	40 hours
Quality Assurance Testing, Technical Documentation & additional related QA tasks	238 hours
Special Project Development	200 hours

The internship began with an 8-hour Company Orientation, during which I was introduced to the company's policies, work environment, organizational structure, and internship guidelines. This was followed by 40 hours of Quality Assurance (QA) Training, where I learned the fundamental testing procedures, documentation practices, and responsibilities expected of a QA intern. After completing the training phase, I rendered 238 hours performing regular QA activities, which included manual application testing, technical documentation, bug verification, and other related QA responsibilities. The remaining 200 hours were dedicated to the completion of the special project, which involved conducting a feasibility study on a QA tool and preparing the corresponding report as the final internship requirement.

Software Used

Due to the Non-Disclosure Agreement (NDA) governing my internship at Kooapps Philippines Corporation, the specific software applications, QA tools, and internal systems used during the internship cannot be disclosed in this report. The following discussion therefore provides a general overview of the software categories and their purposes without revealing confidential company information.

The company uses a third-party communication platform for communicating updates, coordinating work assignments, and sharing company announcements. This platform served as the main channel for identifying what tasks were to be done for the day, checking for updates on reported bugs, and staying up to date with changes or events in the company.

A third-party task management tool is used for posting tickets indicating what application should be tested, what platform it is on, the version to be used, and changelogs on the newest update. The task manager also includes link attachments for the spreadsheets where we will be logging and documenting our findings.

Lastly, the company also utilizes a third-party QA tool that provides testing-related information relevant to the application under evaluation. This tool assists in verifying that application behavior aligns with the expected functionality described in the assigned tasks.

Synthesis of the Practicum Engagement

Learnings

The internship program at Kooapps Philippines Corporation helped me gain substantial insights about Quality Assurance (QA). During the duration of my internship, I gained the capability to perform systematic testing on web and mobile applications through running test cases and reporting errors in an organized manner. I have also learned the significance of observing the smallest details that may affect the functioning of an application.

Additionally, it was made evident to me that a QA expert should be patient and perseverant enough in replicating the reported defects in a certain testing scenario in order to confirm whether these errors exist in the first place or not and if the solution applied to it is working as expected.

I was introduced to QA support tools which give testing information regarding applications being tested. Besides technical capabilities, I also got to hone my professional communication skills by interacting with my supervisors and team members. It became evident to me that good communication is a crucial skill in any workplace setting.

Realization

It became clear to me during the practicum that every professional career poses particular challenges and responsibilities. While the task of identifying software defects seems to be the focal point of the Quality Assurance career, it still requires discipline, persistence, critical mind, and good communicational skills in order to perform the duties successfully. In addition, I learned the importance of being updated on all of the assignments, work news, and projects.

An especially valuable realization was connected with the issue of communication at the workplace. There occurred a situation when I submitted a request on behalf of my colleague, the other intern. The supervisor dealt with this situation in a very professional manner, clarifying that every worker and intern have to make individual contacts and communicate their requests personally. Thus, I realized how important it is to follow the correct procedures of communication, take care of one's own issues and be professional in an organizational environment.

From my own personal view, I understood how much commitment is needed in order to do the job properly. It took me 46 kilometers from my place to the office, and I had to get up very early and leave home in advance to be able to come to the office in time. It was rather difficult, but this experience made me more responsible and punctual.

Conclusion

All in all, my internship engagement at Kooapps Philippines Corporation was very much a valuable learning experience for me. It gave me firsthand experience on professional QA while affording me an opportunity to apply the knowledge and skills that I have acquired through my educational endeavors. More importantly, my internship gave me insight into the key qualities expected of a good professional, such as responsibility, focus, patience, flexibility, good communication skills, and the thirst for continued learning.

The internship has prepared me better for future engagements in the IT field through providing me with knowledge of what is expected in the working environment and the kind of responsibility associated with the job of QA.